

## A Dialogue on Distribution

**Professor:** *And thus we reach our final little piece in the world of operating systems: distributed systems. Since we can't cover much here, we'll sneak in a little intro here in the section on persistence, and focus mostly on distributed file systems. Hope that is OK!*

**Student:** *Sounds OK. But what is a distributed system exactly, oh glorious and all-knowing professor?*

**Professor:** *Well, I bet you know how this is going to go...*

**Student:** *There's a peach?*

**Professor:** *Exactly! But this time, it's far away from you, and may take some time to get the peach. And there are a lot of them! Even worse, sometimes a peach becomes rotten. But you want to make sure that when anybody bites into a peach, they will get a mouthful of deliciousness.*

**Student:** *This peach analogy is working less and less for me.*

**Professor:** *Come on! It's the last one, just go with it.*

**Student:** *Fine.*

**Professor:** *So anyhow, forget about the peaches. Building distributed systems is hard, because things fail all the time. Messages get lost, machines go down, disks corrupt data. It's like the whole world is working against you!*

**Student:** *But I use distributed systems all the time, right?*

**Professor:** *Yes! You do. And... ?*

**Student:** *Well, it seems like they mostly work. After all, when I send a search request to google, it usually comes back in a snap, with some great results! Same thing when I use facebook, or Amazon, and so forth.*